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Footloose in the World of Central Banking

International Meetings and Global Policy Issues

The governor’s annual calendar contains a host of international commitments round the year, much more than I had thought and much more than is possible to cope with. Missed connections, security checks, jet lag, sleep disorder, frequent flyer miles and airport lounge food, all a part of the job content.

The regular meetings on the governor’s annual calendar include the meetings of the IMFC (the International Monetary and Financial Committee of the IMF), the G20 meetings of finance ministers and central bank governors, the bimonthly BIS meetings of central bank governors in Basel and at least one meeting each year of the Asian Consultative Committee, the Asian Currency Union and SAARC governors. There are also regular meetings of finance ministers and central bank governors of BRICS (Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa) that are typically held on the sidelines of the G20 or the IMFC meetings. An incidental by-product of the crisis has been an increase in the number and frequency of these meetings with the result that deciding which meetings to attend and which ones to skip becomes a complex scheduling challenge.

Fund–Bank Meetings

The meetings of the World Bank and the IMF, Fund–Bank meetings, as they are popularly called, are, as I mentioned at the beginning of this book, held twice a year—the spring meetings in April and the annual meetings in October. The meetings are held in Washington, the headquarters of these